directly from the president of the Congress party, rather than from a prime minister heading a coalition government, of which the Congress party was one of the many members.

Some senior Congress leaders, especially Rahul Gandhi, did make some half-hearted, unconvincing and even contradictory statements to clarify their party's role in the November 1984 anti-Sikh pogrom. In October 2013, at an election rally in the village of Kherli in Rajasthan, Rahul Gandhi recalled his association with the two guards who assassinated Indira Gandhi. He said, 'One day, in anger, my friends killed my grandmother … There was anger in me that was like a burden. That anger was throttling me. And one day I understood. This is what happened …' Further, referring to the 2013 Hindu-Muslim riots of Muzaffarnagar, Rahul said, 'As I said before, anger is planted. It does not happen, it is planted … I too am a victim of terrorism … First you plant anger, then you ask, why are you becoming a terrorist? A terrorist is born because anger is planted in him.' [2]

In January 2014, answering a question by Arnab Goswami on the television channel Times Now on the Congress party's likely involvement in the Sikh killings in November 1984, Rahul Gandhi said, 'I remember, I was a child then. I remember that the government was doing everything that it could to stop the riots, trying to stop the killings.' However, he admitted, 'Some Congressmen probably were involved. There is a legal process through which they have gone. Some Congressmen have been punished for it.' [3]

But responding to a question on the 1984 pogrom at the International Institute of Strategic Studies in London on 24 August 2018, Rahul Gandhi said, 'It was a tragedy and painful experience. I don't agree Congress was involved.' Incidentally, that function was organized by Sam Pitroda in his capacity as head of the Indian Overseas Congress, and he was also on the podium during that address. [4]

As late as 4 December 2019, an effort was made to pass the blame for the 1984 pogrom to then Home Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao. Dr Manmohan Singh, speaking at an event at New Delhi